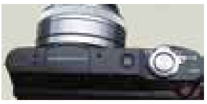


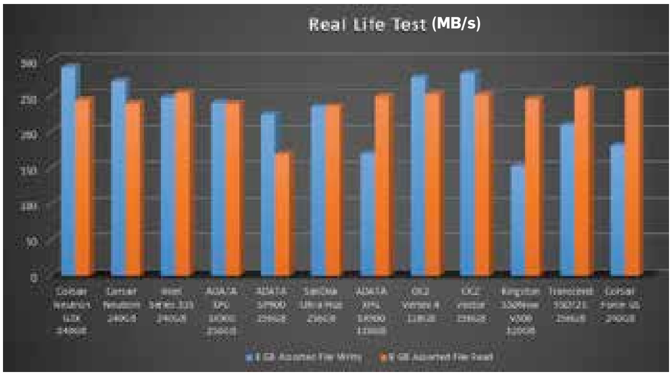
Sony Nex-3N leaked
If rumours are to be believed, Sony's upcoming camera, the Nex-3N has been leaked **http://dgit.in/VYxCfm**

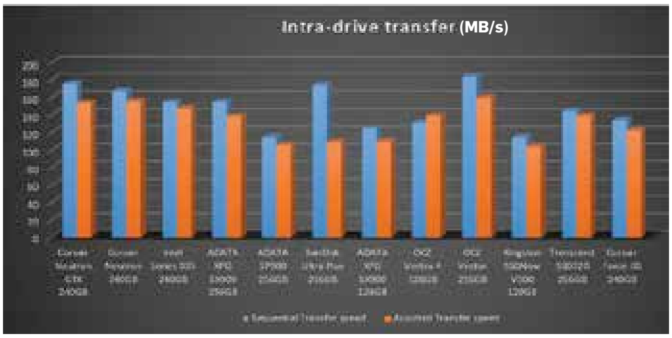
Feeling Pink ?!
Just before Valentines Day this year, Samsung released a "Martian Pink" Galaxy Note II with a matching pink coloured S-pen

are rated at the full 128 GB or 256 GB. This is because ADATA have disabled RAISE (Redundant Array of Independent Silicon Elements) in order to give users more space.

RAISE basically uses a capacity of one NAND chip for data parity, so you will notice that in Corsair and Intel drives, even though you have 16 x 16GB NAND modules which amounts to 256GB of total space, the drives are marketed at 240GB as one entire NAND module goes towards RAISE and over-provisioning. ADATA have disabled RAISE in order to make all the NAND modules available to the user. Over-provisioning cannot be disabled as it would severely affect the SSD's performance in case it were full. After formatting the user-available space is 238GB which is higher than that seen on Corsair of Intel drives.

The enthusiast-oriented XPG SX900 series came in two capacities: 128 GB and 256GB. The internal components of both the drives are similar – SandForce SF-2281 controller, synchronous IMFT NAND modules and both come with a 3.5-inch SSD tray to house it comfortably inside your chassis. We got the 256GB capacity ADATA Premier Pro SP900 which is targetted at the value segment. It comes with an asynchronous IMFT NAND modules, SandForce SF-2281 controller, a 3.5-inch SSD tray and an external casing with USB 3.0 interface to contain the laptop HDD that you will replace with the ADATA SSD. Although the naming convention for the Transced SSD may be a bit confusing, SSD720 is a 256GB flagship SSD from Transcend. Just like the ADATA drives, the Transcend drive also goes for a RAISE-free configuration thereby giving a user-available space of 238 GB (256GB total capacity). It comes in a 7mm profile and houses a SandForce SF-2281 controller alongwith SanDisk's 24nm toggle-mode NAND chips. These SanDisk modules are different from the ones seen in the SanDisk Ultra Plus SSD which had 4 x 64GB modules which help in keeping the power consumption lower than on the Transcend SSD. It comes with a 3.5-inch SSD tray and if you go to the Transcend website, you can download a variety of utilities for cloning your drives, backing up and so on. The last but certainly not the least, were the OCZ SSDs. We got two of their latest models – the OCZ Vertex 4 and the flagship OCZ Vector. The OCZ Vertex 4 houses OCZ's Indilinx IDX400M00BC (which is basically a Marvell controller with customised firmware) controller surrounded by eight synchronous IMFT NAND chips on either side of the printed circuit board and has a whopping 1 GB of cache buffer divided into two 512MB Micron RAM chips on either side of the printed circuit board. It bundles in a 3.5-inch SSD tray.





OCZ Vector256 GB

The other OCZ drive – the flagship OCZ Vector comes in a 7mm profile and a lovely blue colour. It houses Indilinx Barefoot 3 (codenamed IDX500M00-BC) controller which is OCZ's in-house designed SSD controller unlike the one seen in Vertex 4. On opening up the SSD, we come across eight OCZ branded IMFT synchronous NAND modules on each side of the PCB. The controller comes paired with a Micron 2DM77-D9PFJ ICs, which are cache buffer chips of 256MB on each side of the PCB, thus offering a total of 512MB of DDR3L cache buffer. Just like the ADATA and Transcend SSDs, OCZ offers 238GB of unformatted capacity. The Vector SSD will sell in the Indian market soon and will bundle FarCry 3 for free!

PERFORMANCE

Synthetic Benchmarks

While running Crystal Disk Mark with compressible data in sequential tests, most SSDs performed quite well, with OCZ Vector, Transcend SSD720 almost touch the 500 MB/s mark but with incompressible data it was a whole different story. Only OCZ Vector and Corsair Neutron managed to give similar readings as were seen with compressible data. ADATA SP900 which performed great with compressible data took a massive beating with incompressible data which can be attributed to its asynchronous memory